FORGE.

Forged for the everyday.

Brand Identity Kit — Pakistan / 2026

BRAND
FORGE
Everyday apparel & accessories

IDENTITY
Minimal premium
Earth-tone palette

DOCUMENT
Logo · Color · Type
Voice · Packaging

01 — FOUNDATION

Where material becomes object.

FORGE is a minimal-premium everyday apparel brand launching in Lahore, Pakistan in 2026. A forge is where raw material is heated, hammered, and shaped into something durable — a knife that holds its edge through a hundred dinners, a hinge on a door that swings for decades, a tool passed down to the next maker. Nothing leaves a forge that wasn't intentionally built. Wazirabad in Punjab has been Pakistan's forge city for over a century — the place where the country's knives, scissors, and surgical instruments are hammered into shape, where the rhythm of strike-and-cool has been the same sound for four generations. FORGE the brand takes this exact craft logic and applies it to clothing: every garment built to be re-worn 100+ wash cycles, in earth tones drawn from the forge itself — cream ash, warm black iron, terracotta ember, olive slag, sandstone heat-patina.

The visual identity is intentionally restrained — a serif wordmark, a tight five-color earth-tone palette, and disciplined typography. In a Pakistani market saturated with logo-heavy streetwear (LOCAL, Breakout) on one end and ethnic-illustration premium brands (Khaadi, Sapphire) on the other, FORGE occupies the opposite pole: **quiet, typography-led, palette-led**. The identity is built to age well — typography does not go out of style the way seasonal illustrations do, and a tight palette forces discipline across every touchpoint from product tag to Instagram grid.

> FOUR BRAND VALUES
>
> **Craft** — measured, not marketed. GSM disclosed on every product page. **Comfort** — relaxed fits that earn a permanent place in the rotation. **Quiet Confidence** — no loud logos, no all-over graphics, no neon. **Cultural Roots** — earth tones drawn from the Pakistani forge tradition (Wazirabad cutlery, Faisalabad textile mills, Lahore brick kilns) without crossing into costume-y ethnic territory.

02 — LOGO

The Wordmark.

The primary logo is a serif wordmark — **FORGE.** — with a terminal period as a restraint signal. The period is a small typographic gesture that says "this brand is finished thinking about itself." There is no icon, no symbol, no monogram. The wordmark carries the entire brand mark. This is a deliberate UNIQLO / Khaadi-archive move, not a Levi's / Nike move. The wordmark is set in **Playfair Display Bold** (display Latin) or **Noto Serif SC Bold** (CJK + Urdu fallback), at scales ranging from 8pt (hem label) to 156pt (cover).

FORGE.

PRIMARY WORDMARK / PLAYFAIR DISPLAY BLACK / 110PT

Three lockup variants cover every application context. The **primary lockup** places the wordmark on cream against warm-black text — for storefront, packaging, email, and most marketing surfaces. The **inverted lockup** places the wordmark in cream against deep warm brown — for dark-mode UI, hang tags, and the ending page of this document. The **accent lockup** places the wordmark in cream against terracotta clay — used sparingly for seasonal campaigns, Eid capsules, and limited edition drops. No fourth variant is permitted in year 1.

FORGE.

PRIMARY

FORGE.

INVERTED

FORGE.

ACCENT

LOGO CLEAR SPACE & MINIMUM SIZE

Minimum clear space around the wordmark equals the height of the lowercase *a*. Minimum reproduction size is 24pt for print and 32px for screen. Below these thresholds the wordmark loses its serif details and should be replaced by a single initial *a.* in matching weight.

03 — COLOR

Five Earth Tones.

The FORGE palette is exactly five colors — no sixth color is permitted in year 1. The palette is drawn from the forge itself: cream ash (the cool floor of the forge after the fire dies), warm black iron (the metal after quench), terracotta ember (the live fire), olive slag (the residual by-product of the strike), and sandstone heat-patina (the warm tint of heated stone). Cream dominates every surface (60%+ of brand real estate). Warm black handles text and dark surfaces. Terracotta is the single accent — used for rules, labels, and one product colorway

per category. Olive and sandstone serve as secondary product colorways and surface neutrals.

Cream

#FAF7F2

Primary background, paper, packaging base. 60%+ of brand surface area.

Warm Black

#1A1614

Primary text, dark UI surfaces, ending pages. Brown undertone — never pure black.

Terracotta Clay

#8B5A3C

Single accent. Rules, labels, period in wordmark, hero product colorway per category.

Olive

#6B7A4F

Secondary product colorway. Chart fills. Sustainable / earthy product cues.

Sandstone

#C9BBA3

Borders, dividers, surface neutrals, swing tags, secondary packaging. The "in-between" tone.

COLOR RULES — IRON LAW

Never introduce a sixth color. Even seasonal drops must work within these five. **Never pair pure black with cream** — always warm black (#1A1614). **Never use terracotta as a background fill** larger than 200 sq px — it is an accent only. **Never use olive and terracotta in equal area** — terracotta is always the smaller of the two. When in doubt, use cream.

04 — TYPOGRAPHY

Serif Display, Sans Body.

Two typefaces only. **Playfair Display** (or Noto Serif SC for CJK / Urdu compatibility) handles all display text — wordmark, section headers, hero typography on the storefront, tagline. **Inter** (or Noto Sans SC for CJK) handles all body text, product descriptions, UI labels, and packaging copy. The serif-sans pairing is the cleanest editorial combination available — Playfair's high-contrast strokes give FORGE a magazine-grade feel; Inter's neutral grotesque keeps body copy quiet and readable at small sizes.

DISPLAY FACE

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Playfair Display — italic, 400 weight, hero scale

Family: Playfair Display (Latin) · Noto Serif SC (CJK/Urdu fallback) · Tinos (print fallback)
Weights used: 400 regular, 400 italic, 700 bold, 900 black
Use: Wordmark, section titles, hero typography, pull quotes, tagline

BODY FACE

FORGE is everyday clothing with quiet confidence — earth-tone essentials built to be re-worn 100+ times.

Family: Inter (Latin) · Noto Sans SC (CJK/Urdu fallback) · Liberation Sans (print fallback)
Weights used: 400 regular, 500 medium, 600 semibold, 700 bold
Use: Body copy, product descriptions, UI labels, packaging, captions, tables

ROLE	FACE	WEIGHT	SIZE	LINE
Cover wordmark	Playfair Display	900	156px	1.0
Hero typography	Playfair Display	900	56px	1.1
Section title	Playfair Display	700	32px	1.15
Subsection	Playfair Display	700	18px	1.3
Body	Inter	400	13-16px	1.6-1.7

ROLE	FACE	WEIGHT	SIZE	LINE
UI label	Inter	600	11px	1.4
Caption / meta	Inter	500	10px	1.4
Tag (uppercase)	Inter	700	9-10px	1.2

05 — VOICE

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The tagline is four words, present-tense, with a terminal period. It extends the brand-name metaphor without over-explaining it. Used on the storefront hero, the about page, the email signature, and the packaging insert card. The tagline is the brand's shortest complete sentence — everything else flows from its tone: *quiet, second-person, present tense, plain language*.

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PRIMARY TAGLINE / USED ACROSS ALL TOUCHPOINTS / YEAR 1 ONWARD

Voice rules below govern all written communication — product descriptions, Instagram captions, email copy, packaging inserts, and customer service replies. The voice is the single most under-invested brand asset in Pakistani apparel; most brands sound either corporate (Sapphire) or hype-beast (LOCAL). FORGE sounds like a thoughtful friend — confident without being loud, specific without being verbose.

DO — PLAIN LANGUAGE

Use everyday Urdu-English code-switched phrasing where natural. "This hoodie is the one you'll reach for on a Tuesday." Not "Elevate your everyday wardrobe with our signature silhouette."

DO — SPECIFICITY

Name the fabric, the weight, the city. "320 GSM cotton fleece from Faisalabad." Not "Premium cotton blend." Specificity is a quality signal.

DON'T — HYPE WORDS

Avoid "premium," "luxury," "exclusive," "must-have," "game-changing." These words signal the opposite of what they promise.

DON'T — HARD SELLS

No "limited time only," no countdown timers, no "buy now before it's gone." If a product is selling out, just say "back in stock soon."

06 — PACKAGING

Quiet in the Mailer.

Every FORGE order ships in a **kraft mailer** (recycled, uncoated) with a debossed wordmark — no ink print, no full-color sleeve. Inside: the product wrapped in unbranded cream tissue paper, a **handwritten thank-you card** on cream cardstock (the only ink in the package), and a recycled swing tag attached with cotton twine. The unboxing experience is tactile and quiet — no plastic, no foil, no glossy inserts. This costs PKR 28-45 per unit landed, against an industry average of PKR 18-25, but packaging is a primary brand touchpoint worth the premium.

PACKAGING COMPONENTS — YEAR 1



MATERIAL SPECIFICATIONS

Mailer: 250gsm recycled kraft, debossed wordmark, no ink. Sizes S/M/L for apparel. **Tissue:** 18gsm cream acid-free tissue, unbranded. **Card:** 350gsm cream cardstock, A6 size, handwritten "thank you. [founder first name]" in terracotta ink. **Swing tag:** 400gsm recycled kraft with cotton twine, wordmark debossed on front, fabric + care info printed on back. **Sticker seal:** 50mm round, cream with terracotta wordmark, used to seal the mailer flap.

07 — APPLIED

On Product.

The identity is applied across hero product colorways in year 1. Each product category has exactly one terracotta-accented hero SKU; the rest of the category rotates between cream, warm black, olive, and sandstone. The applied examples below show how the wordmark sits on four hero colorways — note that the wordmark is always **debossed or woven**, never screen-printed, never larger than 28mm wide on apparel.



The Daily Tee

Cream / 180gsm combed cotton / PKR 1,800



The Office Polo

Warm Black / 220gsm cotton pique / PKR 3,200



The Drop Tee

Terracotta / 200gsm combed cotton / PKR 2,600



The Crew Sweat

Olive / 280gsm french terry / PKR 3,500

APPLICATION RULES

Apparel: Wordmark debossed on inside collar (12pt), woven label at left hem (max 28mm wide). Never on the chest, never on the back. **Accessories (mugs):** Wordmark centered on opposite side of handle, 24pt, terracotta on cream or cream on warm-black. **Notebooks:** Wordmark debossed on front cover, centered, 32pt. **Digital:** Wordmark in nav at 18-22px, in email header at 48-72px. Never below 14px (use single-letter *a.* fallback).

END OF DOCUMENT

Built to be re-worn.

This identity kit is a working document. It will be revised at the end of every season — colors will not change, typography will not change, but the applied examples and packaging specs will evolve as the brand learns what works on real customers in real mailboxes across Pakistan.

DOCUMENT

Brand Identity Kit v1.0
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NEXT REVIEW

End of Season 1
March 2027